

Module 000

Install Claude Desktop

COURSE	AI Workshop 2.0, Desktop Edition
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YOU NEED	A Mac or PC and a paid Claude plan

Install Claude Desktop

Getting set up takes about ten minutes. There is nothing to configure and nothing to type into a command line.

What you need first

REQUIREMENT	DETAIL
A computer	Mac (macOS 13 or later) or Windows (Windows 10 or later)
A paid Claude plan	Pro or Max. The Code tab is not available on the free plan
Ten minutes	Downloading and signing in is most of it

Nothing else. No code editor, no developer account, nothing to install alongside it.

Step 1: Download and sign in

Go to **claude.ai/download** and install Claude Desktop the normal way for your machine. Open it and sign in with the account your paid plan sits on.

If you already use Claude in a browser, this is the same account and the same conversations.

Step 2: Open the Code tab

Claude Desktop has several tabs down the side. The one this course uses is called **Code**.

Chat is for talking. Code is for working on a folder of files. Everything in Modules 1 to 5 happens in the Code tab.

Step 3: Make your project folder

Create one folder for your Claude work. Put it somewhere you will find it again, such as your Documents folder, and call it:

Claude-projects

Leave it empty. Claude fills it as you go.

Step 4: Point Claude at that folder

In the Code tab, look along the top of the window. Next to the name of your session there is a small **folder icon**. Click it, choose **Change directory**, and pick the `Claude-projects` folder you just made.

That is the single step people get wrong, so it is worth being precise about two things:

- The search box in the Files panel on the right is **not** the folder picker. It only searches inside the folder you are already in.
- The name of your current folder shows next to the session title. Glance at it whenever you start work, because a new session opens in whichever folder you used last.

Step 5: See a decision board

The last thing to do is meet the way Claude asks you questions in this course.

Drag `MODULE-000-GIVE-TO-CLAUDE.md` from this folder into the chat, type the line below, and press send:

Follow the instructions in this file, one step at a time.

Claude will confirm your folder, create a small file so you can see it working, then ask you a question as a set of clickable cards. Click one. That is the pattern for the whole course.

How every module works from here

1. Read the module's `READ.pdf` .
2. Drag the module's `GIVE-T0-CLAUDE.md` into the chat with that same line.
3. Click your answers.
4. Check the result before moving on.

Five modules, same four steps. Module 1 is next.

If you would rather use a command line

The original command-line version of this course is still available. See `ADVANCED-terminal-install.md` in this folder. You do not need it, and nothing later in the course assumes it.